



August 18, 2025

ELECTRONIC SUBMISSION TO <http://comments.ustr.gov>

Ms. Jennifer Thornton
Office of the U.S. Trade Representative
600 17th Street NW
Washington, D.C. 20508

Re: Request to Appear at the Public Hearing on the Section 301 Investigation of Brazil and Summary of Testimony on Ethanol Market Access Issues (USTR-2025-0044)

Dear Ms. Thornton:

As President of the National Corn Growers Association (NCGA), I hereby submit this request to appear at the public hearing to be held on September 3, 2025 relating to the Office of the U.S. Trade Representative's Section 301 Investigation of Brazil.

I look forward to addressing the topics requested by USTR, specifically related to Brazil's unreasonable, discriminatory, and burdensome ethanol market access policies. In particular, I plan to highlight the following issues of importance to our over 36,000 dues-paying members supporting the interests of over 500,000 corn growers across the United States:

- Brazil has enjoyed preferential market conditions while simultaneously erecting barriers that restrict and prevent access for American corn and ethanol exporters. Brazil was once a top market for American ethanol exports, but their 18 percent tariff has eradicated this market.
- Brazil's continued lack of reciprocity prohibits American ethanol producers from participating on a level playing field. Further, their engagement in global organizations seeks to prevent American corn ethanol from accessing future markets in aviation fuels that could experience exponential growth in the coming years.
- Brazil is actively looking to unseat the historic and obvious success of the American corn industry by a series of trade actions that directly and indirectly harm U.S. corn growers. American corn growers are the most productive and efficient farmers in the world, harvesting and exporting the highest quality of corn. Approximately 30 percent of the U.S. corn crop is reliant on exports valued at \$22 billion in 2024, which supports more than 144,000 full-time jobs in the United States generating over \$48 billion of domestic economic activity. Currently, farmers are faced with challenging market conditions including high input costs, low corn prices, and sluggish market growth. At a time when growing global demand is vital for the success of farmers, Brazil's policies have reduced

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demand for U.S. corn, contributing to the tough economic environment facing farmers today.

We are encouraged that this Administration has launched this investigation into Brazil's unfair ethanol market access practices. For too long, Brazil has avoided answering to America's farmers, and we are eager to demonstrate our continuous subjection to unwarranted trade barriers.

Thank you for the opportunity to provide NCGA's views.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Kenneth R. Hartman Jr." The signature is written in a cursive, flowing style.

Kenneth R. Hartman, Jr.
President
National Corn Growers Association